APRL Actuates Valves, sees New Club Structure, Visual Update, New Website and Record Number of Potential New Members to Date.

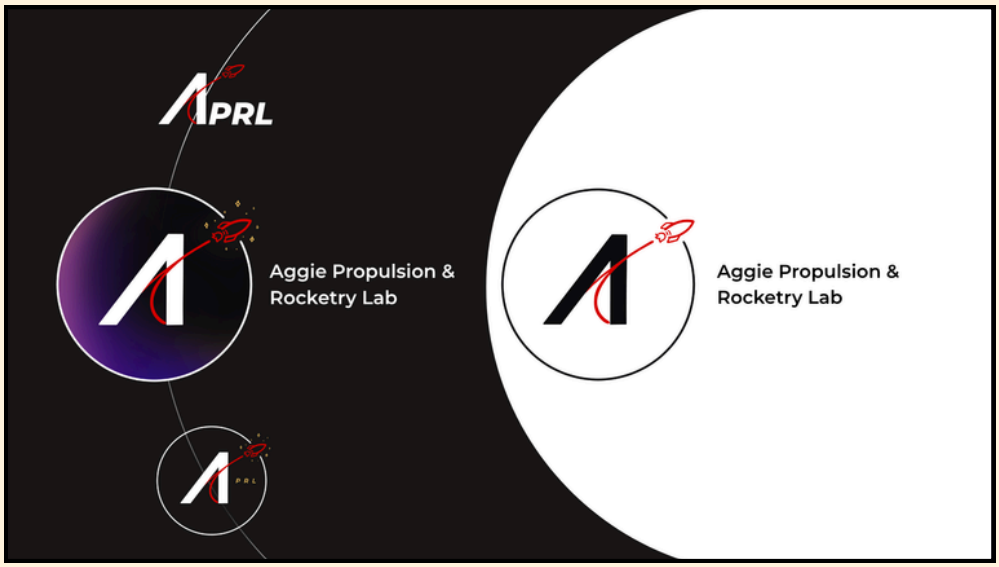
by Business & Operations

Welcome to The APRL Archives! The official APRL newsletter committed to bringing students, alumni, and the general public up-to-date and excited to be supporting APRL!

Although the Summer heat this year had grown hotter with great intensity seemingly every week, Aggie Propulsion & Rocketry Lab (APRL) has taken fast strides to cruise into the 2026 Fall Quarter. Efforts made by the club to extend outreach and club presence have led to a record-breaking number of potential new members in APRL history, as the club has seen more than 200 people join the official Discord since the rebrand went live on Tuesday, September 22nd. New club structuring has seen a tentative schedule set in stone, and dates for key project testing have been decided.

APRL Welcomes a New Title: Project Manager!

The student organization has seen an extensive structural overhaul in regard to how tasks and operations within the club are handled and organized. New to the club, a Project Manager role has been created and is held by Daniel Fan, also a continuing Electrical Lead. This introduction begins a new system in which follows the following order: Project Manager (Captain), Chief Engineer of Propulsion (Captain), and Chief Engineer of Vehicle (Captain). Differently from Propulsion and Vehicle Chiefs, the Project Manager serves as a central figure who oversees all subteams, including those not under Propulsion and Vehicle such as the Electrical, Controls, and Business & Operations. Additionally, the Project Manager serves as their Captain to observe their respective contributions to APRL projects.



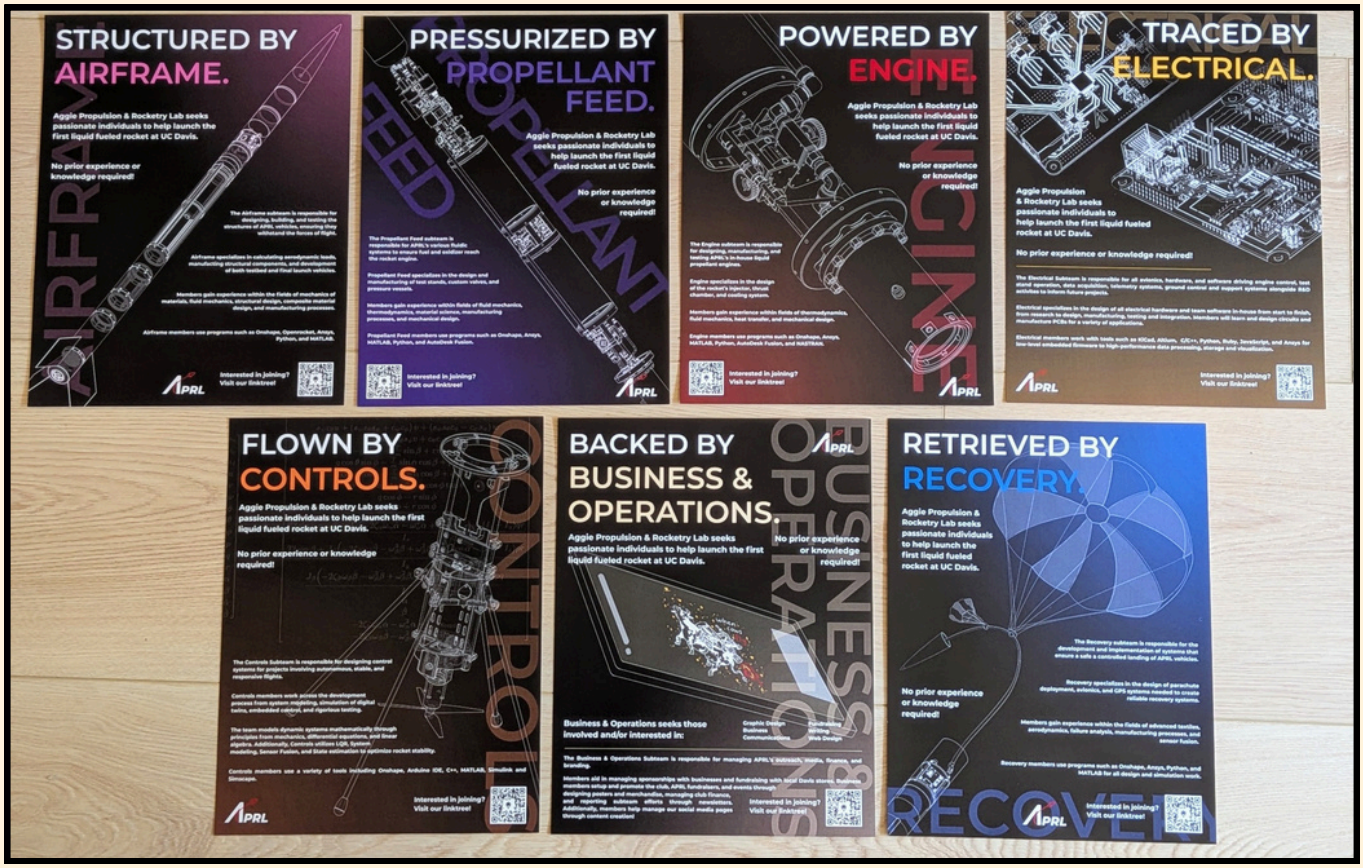
Branding update featuring modified logo designs.

The recent introduction of a Project Manager follows the new overarching goal for APRL this academic year: to be able to ensure ownership/leadership of projects and their requirements, maximizing effiency and team communication, organizational management, project execution, and scheduling.

Visual Update brings APRL to modernity.

With the 2026 - 2027 academic year at UC Davis proving to be a potentially pivotal point for APRL's existence, the Business & Operations subteam has launched a visual update in

ENGINE
PROPELLANT FEED
RECOVERY
AIRFRAME
ELECTRICAL
CONTROLS
BUSINESS & OPERATIONS



Subteam specific posters!

in order to cement the club's new commitment towards expanding media and outreach.

The visual update has seen a refreshed and refined APRL logo, subteam color identities, and a clear club theme, all while maintaining our a level of simplicity and professionalism that APRL has always been known for. The updated logo brings color and a small refresh while remaining minimal, staying true to the club's origin. Many variations on the logo ensure adaptability to media, a must-have as APRL's social media presence begins to grow.

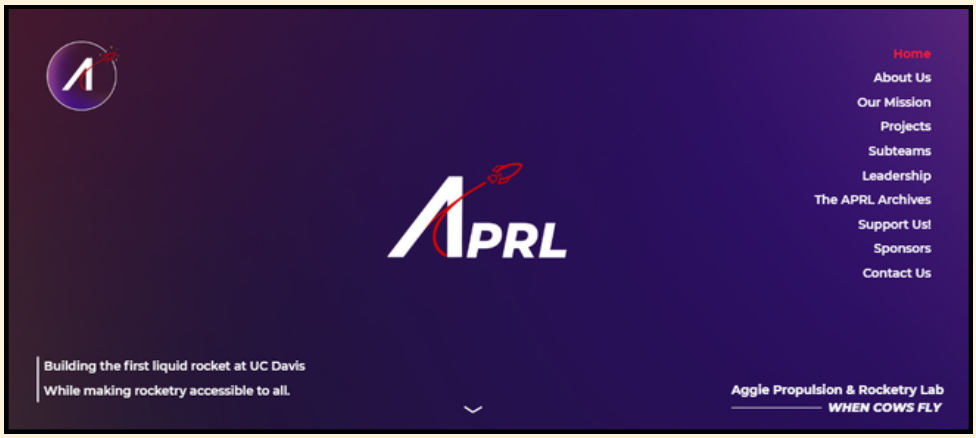
Additionally, all Subteams now have their own unique color! Our new color palette has already implemented oncertain projects, such as our new recruitment posters!

The visual update has also been implemented into APRL's social media accounts such as discord, instagram, and our new, redesigned website!

When/Where Cows Fly: APRL's Overhauled Website is now live!

The Business & Operations subteam has been hard at work drafting and coding a complete overhaul of APRL's website. The new site features consistent theming and an in-the-works completed project pages about all our projects!

Visit the official Aggie Propulsion & Rocketry Lab website at aprl.space



Overhauled website homepage concept!

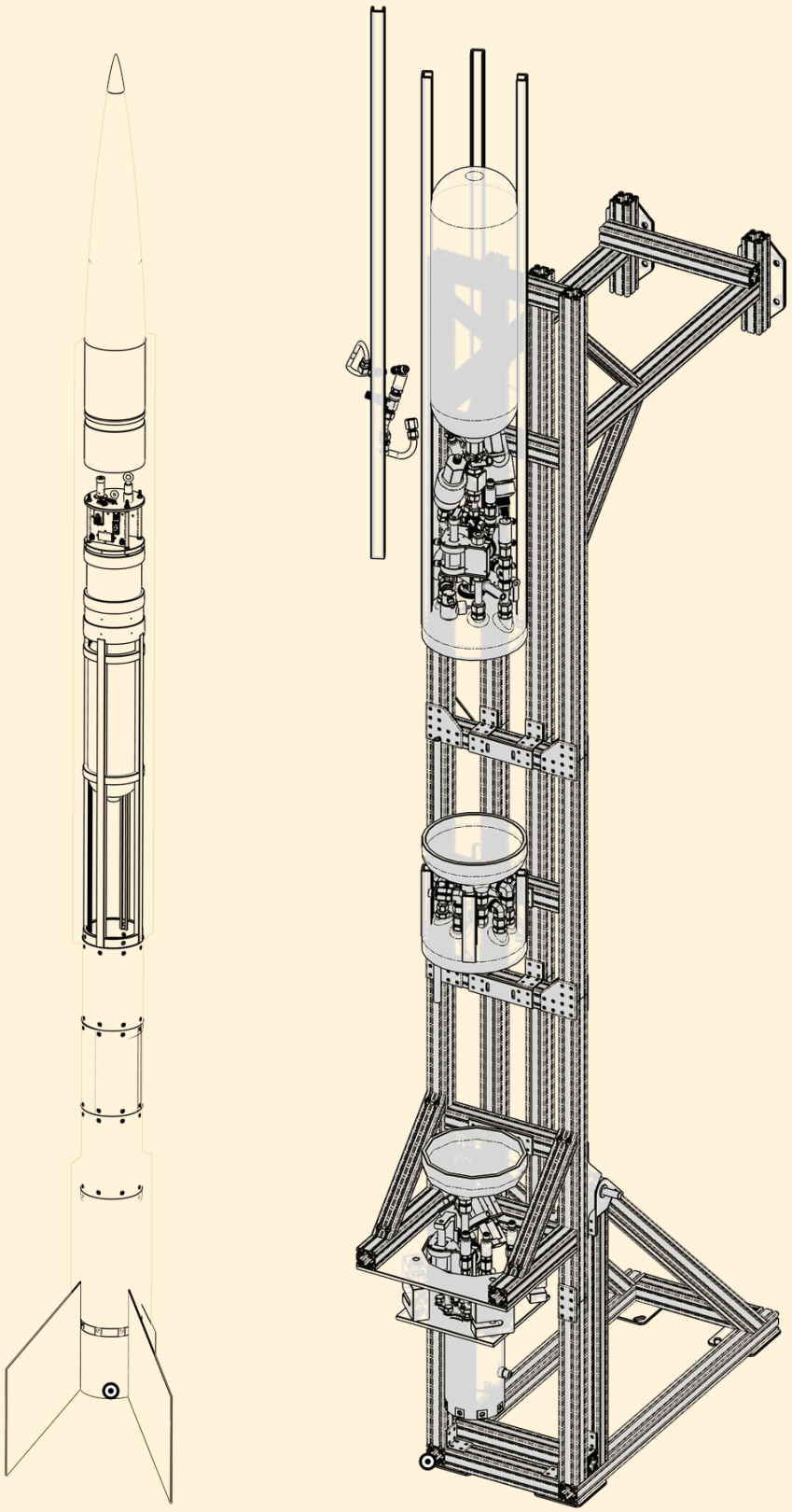
November 21st, 2026 set as the Official Date for VTS hotfire and Ophiotaurus launch.

by Business & Operations

With the new quarter beginning, APRL leads have locked in a tentative schedule for the first hotfire of Propulsion's Vertical Test Stand system, VTS, as well as the launch of Vehicle's solid full subscale rocket named Ophiotaurus. The group targets for November 21st, and plans to complete final parts purchasing, complete manufacturing, and full testing procedures have been scheduled for both projects to ensure they are ready for transit and setup at the Friends of Amateur Rocketry site.

VTS and Ophiotaurus are key projects for APRL, as both projects will lead into the production and launch of APRL's first liquid fueled rocket. VTS will prove the culmination of work from Engine, Propellant Feed, and Electrical systems are functioning properly. Similarly, the launch of Ophiotaurus will demonstrate that the Airframe and Recovery systems are in working order for a successful flight.

These pivotal events will accelerate APRL into achieving our goals by a targeted end of the 2026-2027 academic year. A goal in the making since the beginning of APRL, and a goal that seems closer than ever to achieving.



Current models of both Ophiotaurus (left) and Vertical Test Stand (right).

2026 - 2027 Leads

Project Manager - Daniel Fan

Chief Engineer of Propulsion - Charan Sampath

Chief Engineer of Vehicle - Natasha Alvarenga

Engine Lead - Jasper Dratt

Propellant Feed Leads - Cole Walker, Rubi Rodriguez

Airframe Leads - Adam Pratt Dermer, Samuel Sargent Walker, Atreganson “Trey” Lowry

Recovery Lead - Eva Zhou

Electrical Leads - Nolan Poe, Daniel Fan

Controls Lead - Lucas Bauckman

Business & Operations Leads - Vaughn Bui, Benjamin Nguyen